



should be removed, to allow the roots to become smooth and large.

HARVESTING

Roots can be lifted when they are the size of tennis balls, but will go on swelling until early winter.

STORING

Celeriac can be left in the ground over winter in mild regions; pull a layer of soil up over the roots to protect them. In cold areas, dig up the roots, remove the foliage, and store in boxes of sand or soil to prevent the roots from drying out. Roots will remain sound until early spring.

PESTS AND DISEASES

Celeriac is vulnerable to several pests and diseases. The maggots of celery leaf fly mine holes in foliage, creating brown, dry patches and causing the stem to become stringy. Remove and destroy infected leaves and treat with fungicide. Carrot fly is also strongly attracted to celeriac—cover crops with fine, insect-proof mesh or horticultural fleece to prevent them from reaching and mining the roots (see pp.174-5).

Celery leaf spot disease creates brown patches on leaves. Remove and destroy any infected plant material.